

CONFIDENTIAL

FLEET LOGISTIC AIR WING, ATLANTIC/CONTINENTAL
AIR TRANSPORT SQUADRON ONE
U. S. NAVAL AIR STATION
PATUXENT RIVER, MARYLAND

10 February 1951

CONFIDENTIAL

MEMORANDUM REPORT to Commanding Officer, Air Transport Squadron ONE

Subj: Report of Unusual Sighting on Flight 125/9 February 1951

I, Graham E. BETHUNE, was Co-Pilot on Flight 125 from Keflavik, Iceland to Naval Air Station, Argentina on the 10th of February 1951. At 0055X I signed and observed the following object:

While flying in the left seat at 10,000 feet on a true course of 230 degrees at a position of 49-50 North 50-03 West, I observed a glow of light below the horizon about 1,000 to 1,500 feet above the water. Its bearing was about 2 O'Clock. There was no overcast, there was a thin transparent group of scuds at about 2,000 feet altitude. After examining KINGDON the object for 40 to 50 seconds I called it to the attention of Lieutenant KINGDON in the right hand seat. It was under the thin scuds at roughly 30 to 40 miles away. I asked "What is it, a ship lighted up or a city, I know it can't be a city because we are over 250 miles out." We both observed its course and motion for about 4 or 5 minutes before calling it to the attention of the other crew members. Its first glow was a dull yellow. We were on an interloping course. Suddenly its angle of attack changed, its altitude and size increased as though its speed was in excess of 1,000 miles per hour. It closed in so fast that the first feeling was we would collide in mid air. At this time its angle changed and the color changed. It then ^{WAS} definitely circular and redish orange on its prmiter. It reversed its course and tripled its speed until it was last seen disappearing over the horizon. Because of our altitude and misleading distance over water it is almost impossible to estimate its size, distance and speed. A rough estimate would be at least 300 feet in diameter, over 1,000 miles per hour in speed and approached within 5 miles of the aircraft.

WITH US AFTER OBTAINING A POSITION OF ABOUT 1,500 FEET THEN FLEW
IN FRONT OF AIRCRAFT ABOUT 45° /s/Graham E. BETHUNE

Lt, U.S. Naval Reserve

U.S. NAVY INTELLIGENCE REPORT 1451

NO SIGNATURE

WORDS MISHELED

A SENTANCE MISSING

WAS RETYPED

ENCLOSURE (4)

UNCLASSIFIED

90

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At 0055Z on 10 February 1951, while serving as second Plane Commander on above flight, I was an eye witness to an unusual sighting of an unidentified object. This occurrence took place at approximately 49-50 N and 50-03 W, which is approximately 200 miles north east of Argentina, Newfoundland. We were at 10,000 feet altitude cruising on a true course of about 230° at time of incident. (200)

At time of sighting I was occupying the right hand (CoPilots) seat and the left hand (Pilots) seat was occupied by Lieutenant G. E. BETHUNE.

My attention was first called to the occurrence by Mr. BETHUNE, who asked me to look at an unusual light which was to my right. I then saw that there was a glowing light beneath a thin layer of strato-form clouds beneath us. This light was to my right and down at an angle of about 45°. This object appeared to lie on the surface and was throwing a yellowish-orange glare through the cloud deck. It appeared to be very large and I at first thought that it could be a large ship completely illuminated.

Mr. BETHUNE and I watched the object for several minutes in trying to determine its nature. We then called our Navigator, Lieutenant N. J. P. ROGER to the cockpit to scrutinize the object and render his opinion as to its nature.

While further observing the object I saw that it suddenly started ascending through the cloud layer and it then became quite bright. The object was very large and was circular with a glowing yellow-orange ring around its outer edge. This object appeared to be climbing and moving at a tremendous speed, and it appeared to be on a more or less collision course with our aircraft. When it appeared that there was a possibility of collision the object appeared to make a 180° turn and disappeared over the horizon at a terrific speed. During the course of events LTJG A. L. JONES had come to the cockpit and he made a turn in the direction of the object but it went out of sight in a short period of time.

Due to the fact that this object was seen over water at night it would be most difficult for me to estimate speed, size or distance we were from it during the course of events. However, the speed was tremendous and the size was at least 200 to 300 feet in diameter. The object was close enough to me to see and observe it clearly. (11)

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DOWNGRADED AT 3 YEAR INTERVALS
DECLASSIFIED AFTER 12 YEARS.

UNCLASSIFIED

91.

Upon request, I will attempt to submit a more detailed and complete report of my observations.

Upon arrival at NAS, Argentina, I was contacted by Capt. D. H. PAULSEN, USAF, who interrogated me relative to the subject.

/s/ Fred W. KINGDON, Jr.
LT, U. S. Navy.

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DOD DIR 5200.10

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